Eionet Thematic Group on Digital Capabilities and AI



In-Person meeting in Copenhagen

September 29-30, 2026

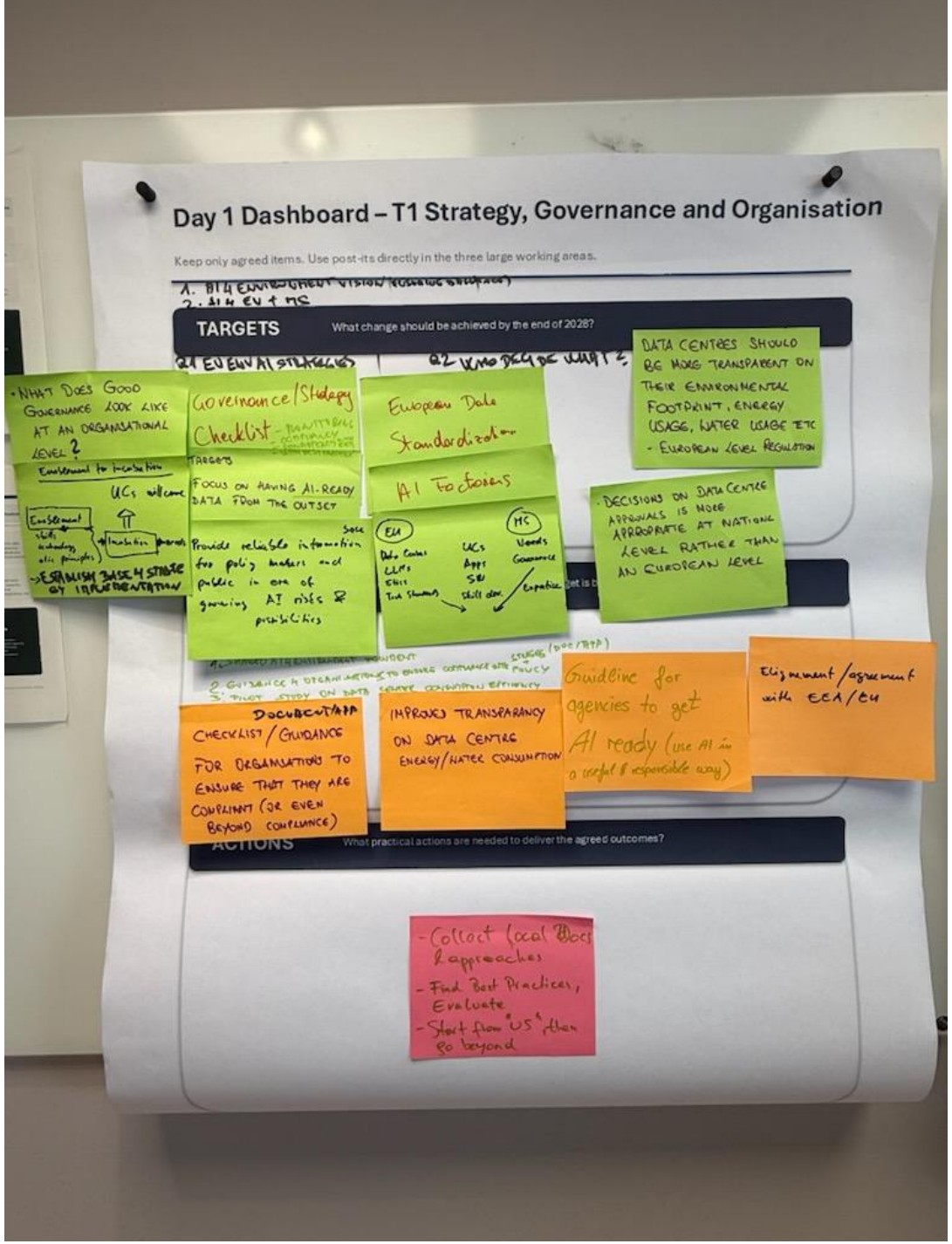
Summary

European Environment Agency

Topics

- **T1: Strategy, Governance and Organisation**
- **T2: People, Skills and Ways of Working**
- **T3: Data, Technologies and Infrastructure**
- **T4: AI Applications and Value Creation**

- Targets
- Outcomes
- Actions



T1: Strategy, Governance and Organisation

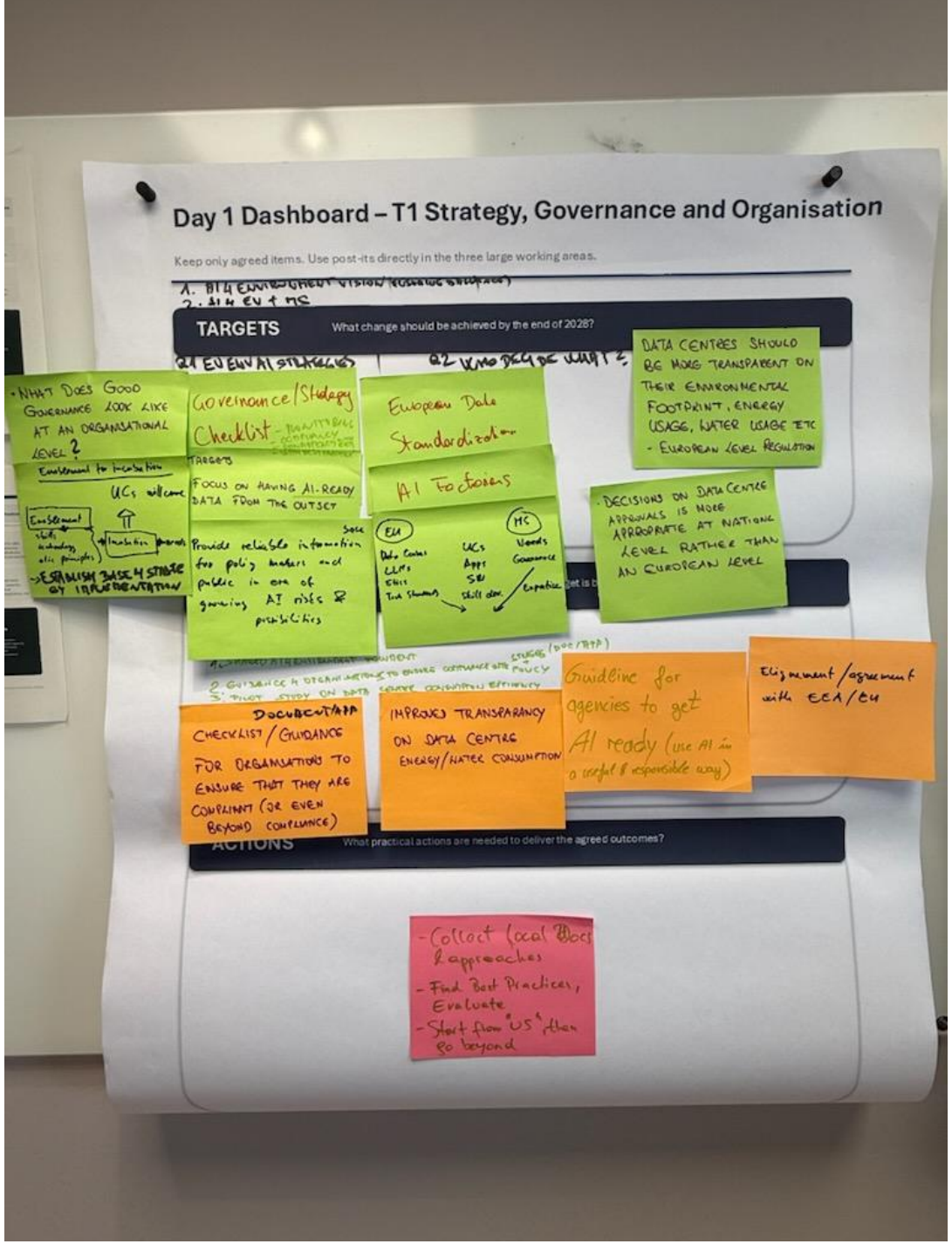
TARGETS

- AI for the environment: EU strategies by Q1 2027. Q2: who decides what?
- Define organisational AI governance and a checklist for monitoring, compliance, EEA alignment and best practice.
- Support needs-led incubation with skills, technology and ethics. Build AI-ready data from the outset.

Provide reliable information for policymakers and the public amid AI risks and opportunities.

EU AND MEMBER STATE ROLES

EU: European data, standardisation, AI factories, data centres, LLMs, ethics and technical standards.
Member States: needs, governance and expertise to inform use cases, apps, possible software and skills development.
Propose EU rules for transparent data-centre environmental, energy and water footprints. Keep approvals at national level.

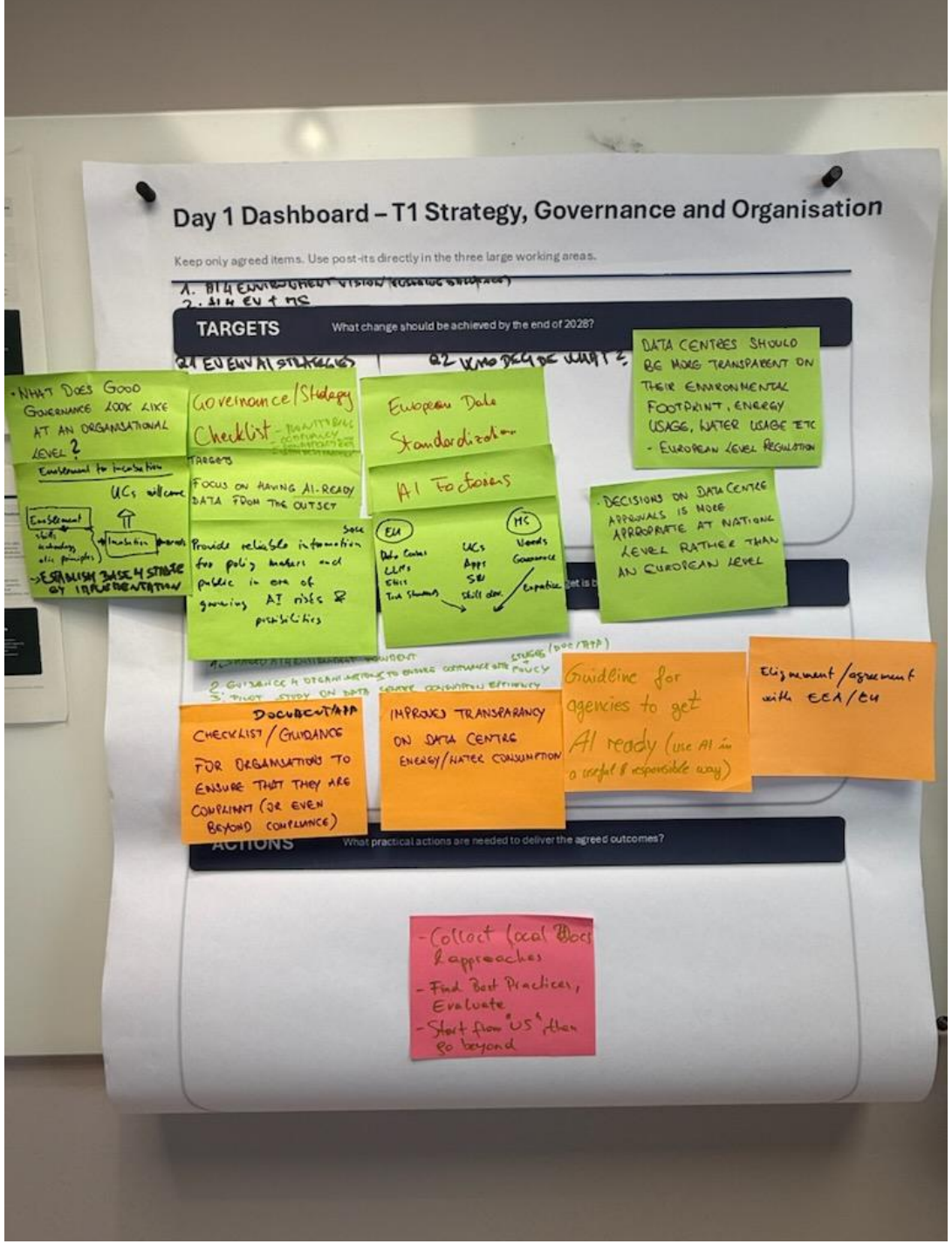


T1: Strategy, Governance and Organisation

OUTCOMES

- Shared AI for Environment empowerment
- Guidance for organisations to ensure compliance with Strategy + policy (POC/ATP).
- Pilot study on data center consumption efficiency

- Documentation, checklists and guidance for For orgnisations to ensure that they are compliant (or even beyond-compliance).
- Improved transparency of data-centre energy and water consumption.
- Guidelines supporting agencies in becoming AI-ready and using AI in a useful and responsible way.
- Alignment/Agreement with EEA/EU.



T1: Strategy, Governance and Organisation

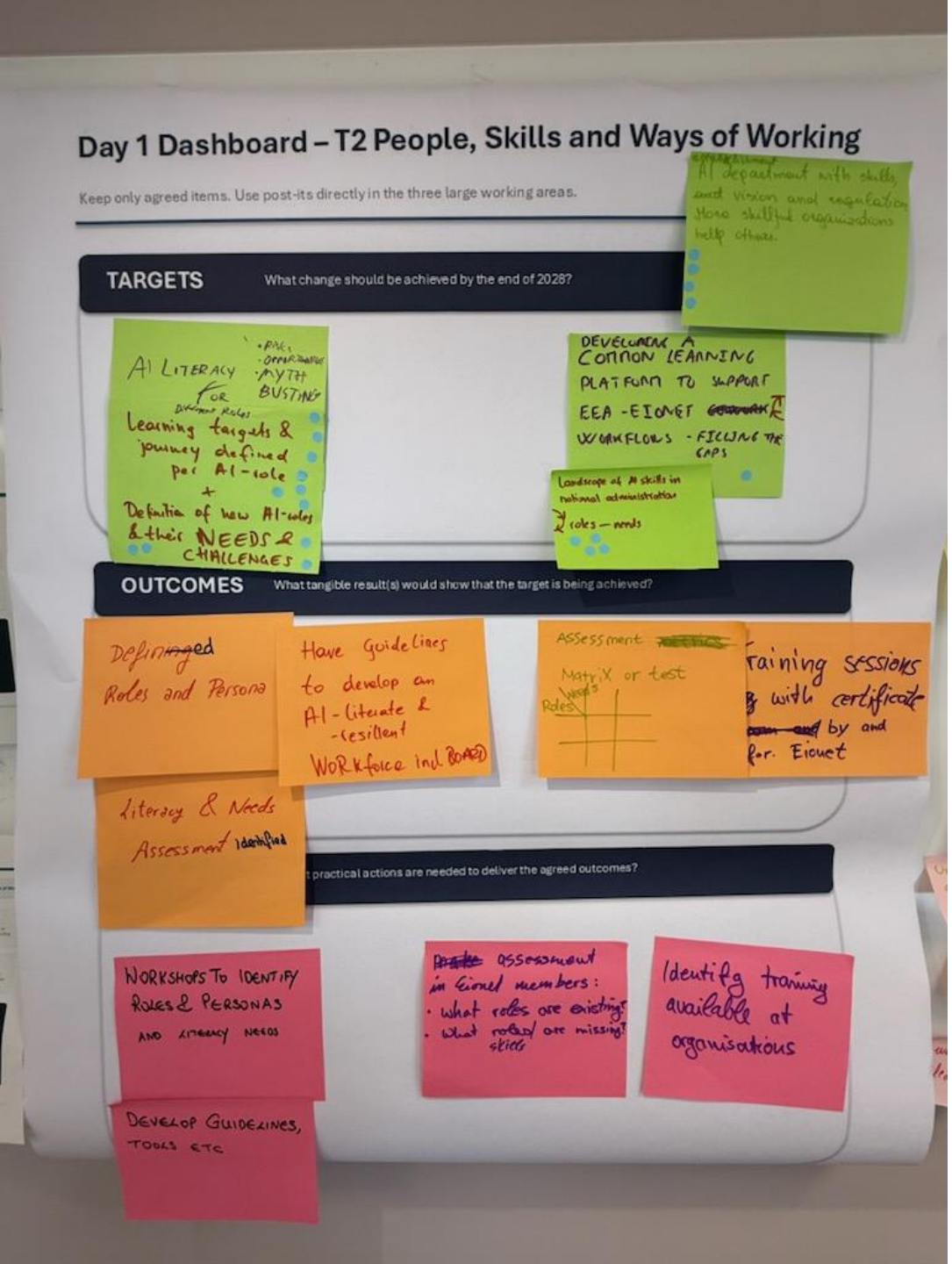
ACTIONS

- Collect local Docs and approaches.
- Identify and evaluate best practices.
- Start with internal experience and then broaden the exercise beyond.

Group: T1 Strategy, Governance and Organisation

Annalisa	Start doing research on European (MS) strategies/policies
Martin T.	Contribute to summary of event. Propose input to roadmap. Initiate the outcomes template. Contribute to topics coordination
Juliana	Talk with colleagues for more ideas on this topic
Stephen (IE)	Identify the toles/levels in the organisation relevant to the governance/oversight of AI and stat to collect info from Member States
Sune	Provide support to Group and share knowledge
Stephan	
Davide	Share experiences in other networks and coalitions on AI
Alberto	
Erkki	Identify information needs for AI Env. Impact
Simon	

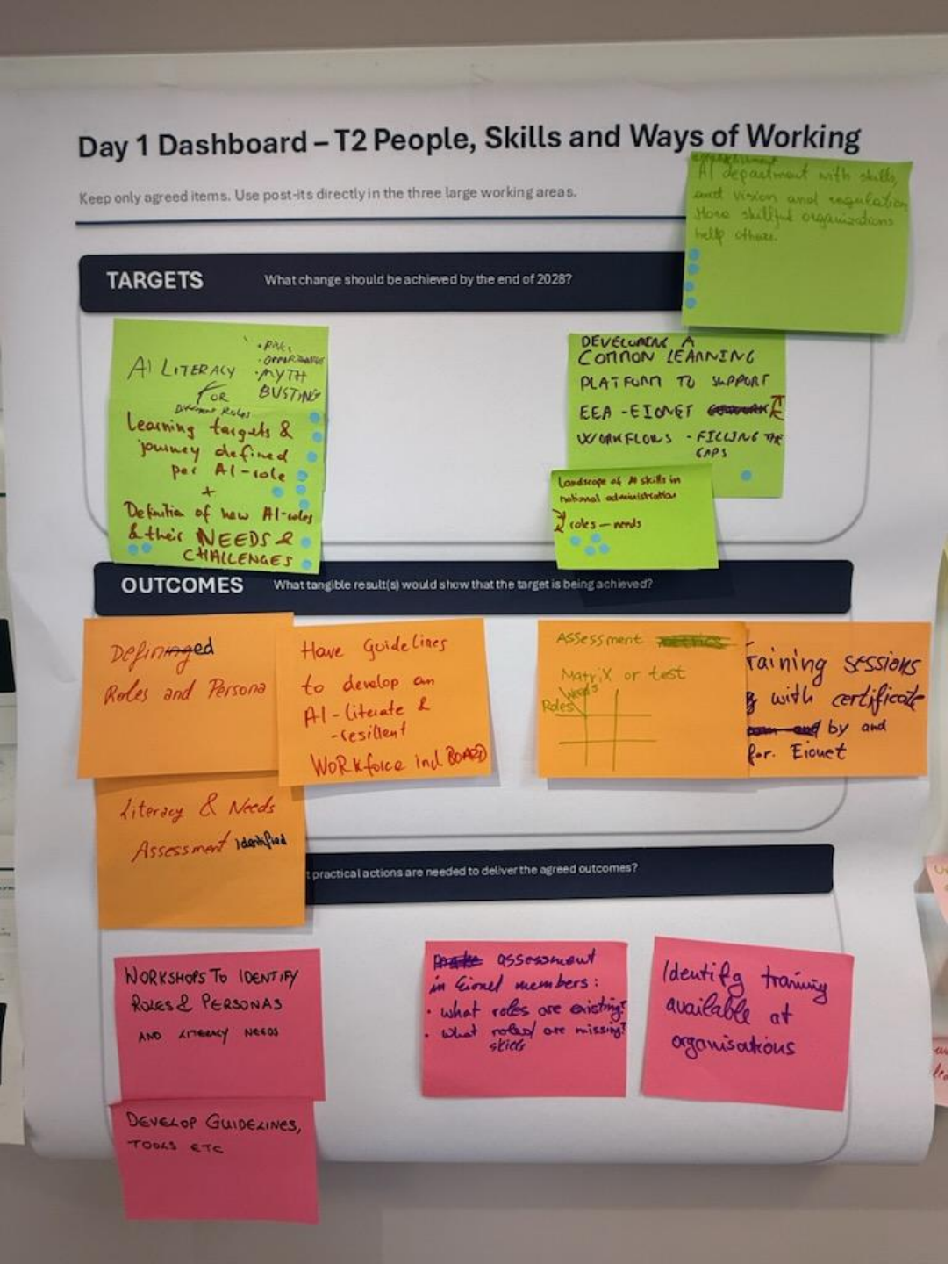




T2: People, Skills and Ways of Working

TARGETS

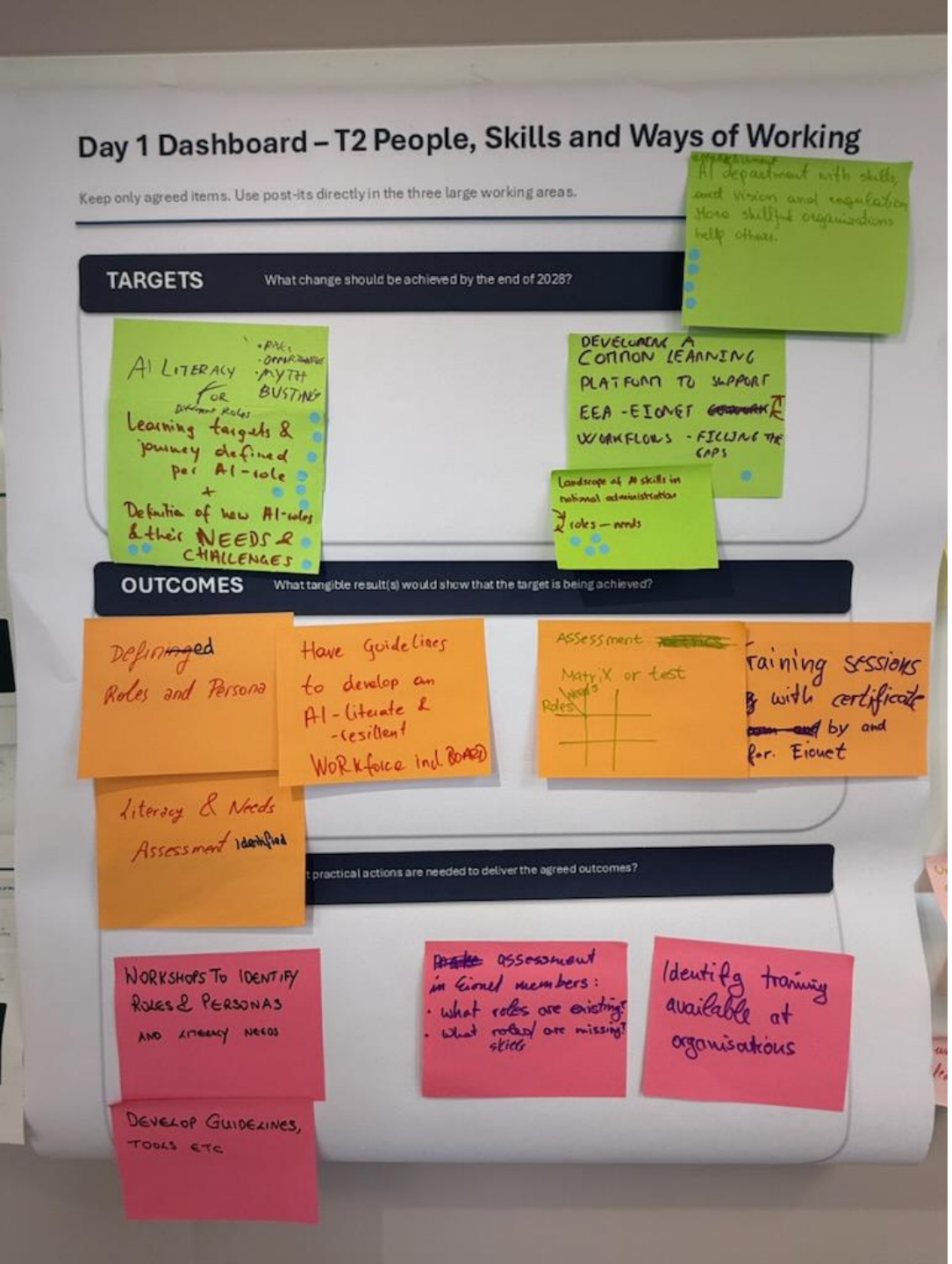
- Establish AI literacy for different roles.
- Risks, Opportunities, Myth Busting
- Learning targets and journey defined per AI role +
- Definition of new AI roles, including their needs and challenges.
- Develop a common learning platform supporting EEA-Eionet workflows and filling identified gaps.
- Map the landscape of AI skills, roles and needs in national administrations.
- Establishment of AI department with skills, vision and regulation. More skillfull organisations support others



T2: People, Skills and Ways of Working

OUTCOMES

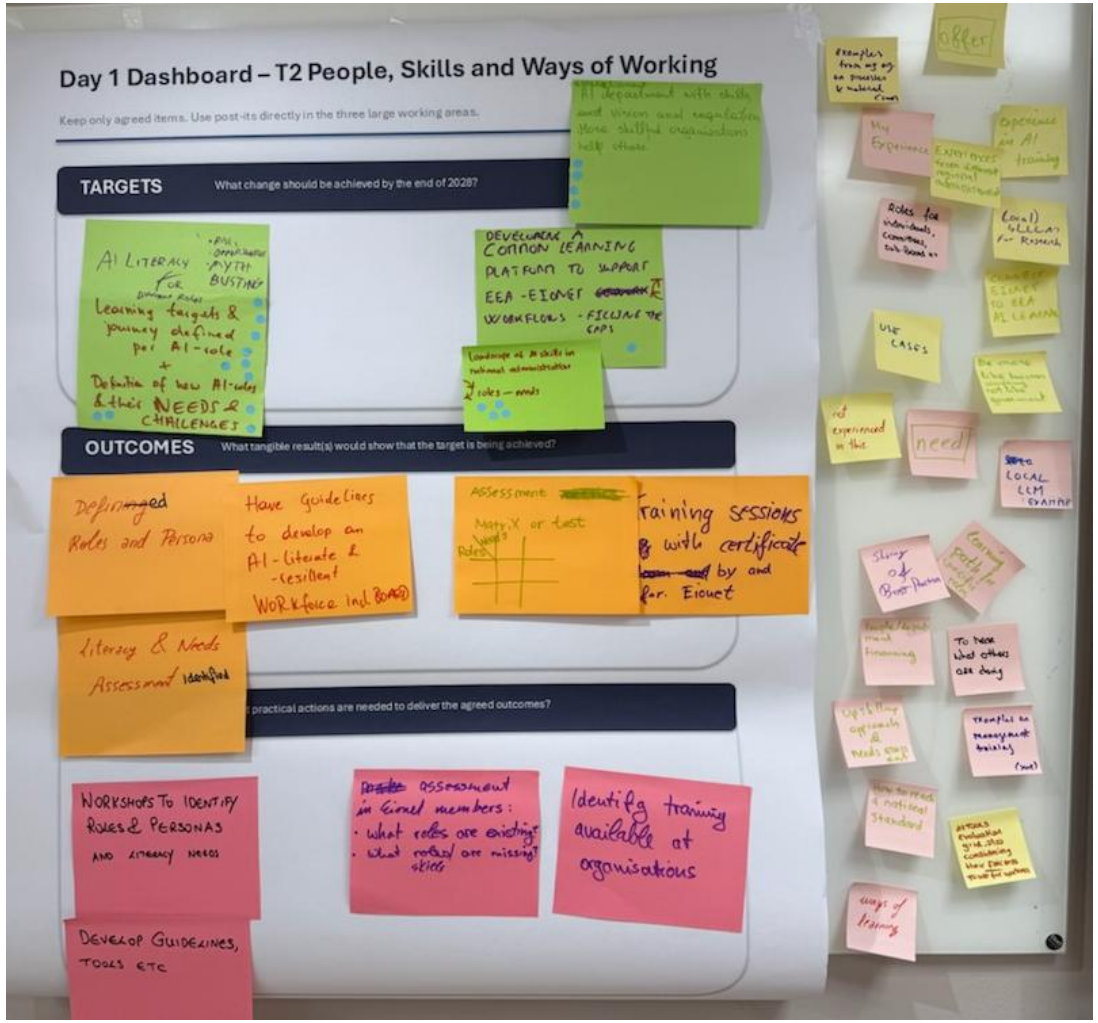
- Defined roles and personas.
- Literacy and need assessment identified
- Have guidelines to develop and AI literate and resilient work force including board
- An assessment matrix or test linking roles and needs.
- Training sessions with certification by and for Eionet.



T2: People, Skills and Ways of Working

ACTIONS

- Conduct workshops to identify roles, personas and literacy needs.
- Develop supporting guidelines and tools etc.
- Assess existing and missing roles and skills across Eionet members.
- Identify training already available within organisations.



T2: People, Skills and Ways of Working

OFFERS

Examples from my organsation on processes and matriels
My experience
Experiences from different regional administrations
Experience in AI training
Roles fro individuals, comittees, sub boards (KT)
Local LLM for research
Connect Eionet to EEA AI learning
Use Cases
Be more like Business company not like government
Not experienced in this

NEED

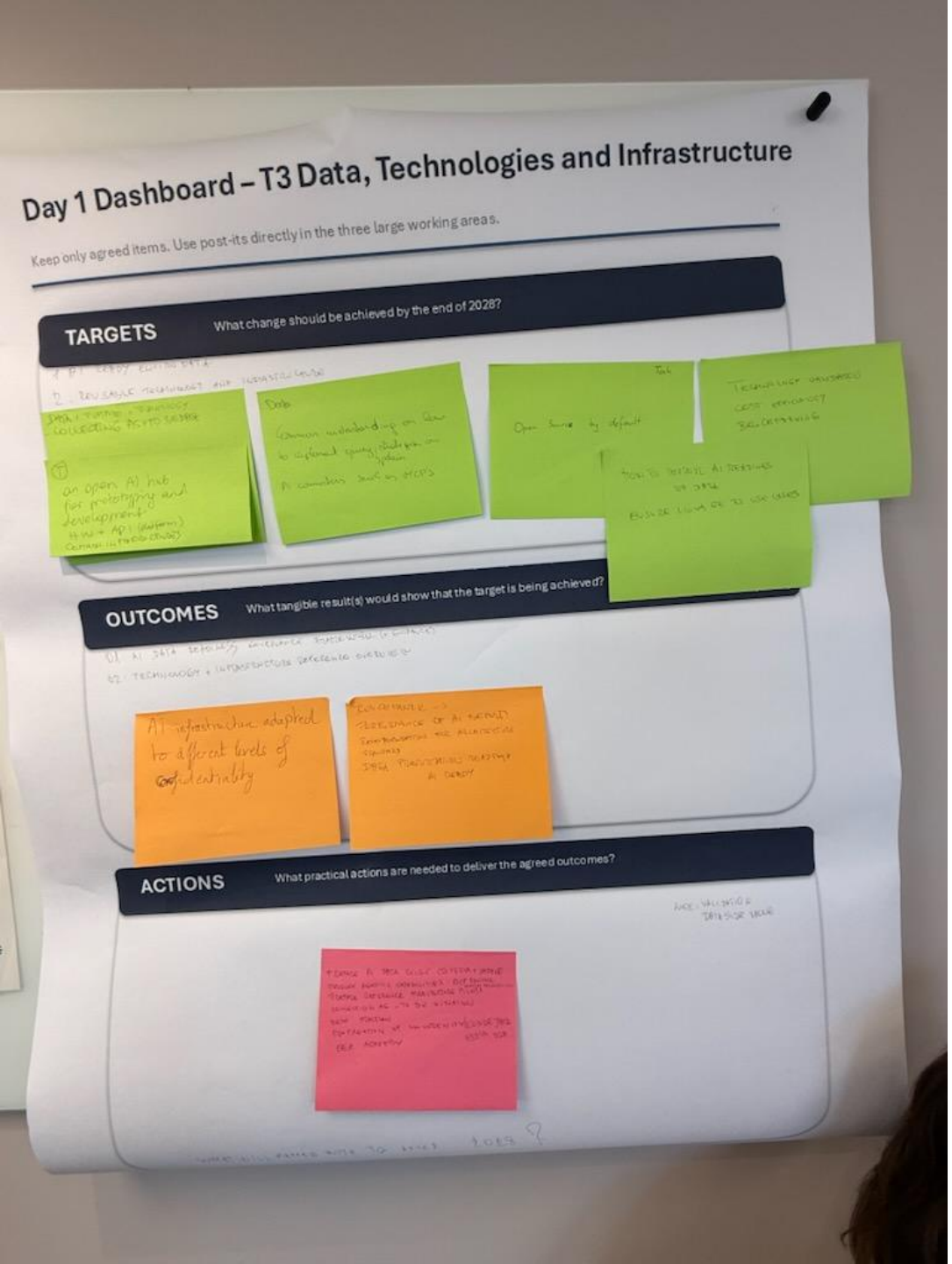
Local LLM Example
Sharing of best practices
Learning path for specific roles
To hear what others are doing
People/Department financing
Upskilling approach and needs assessment
Examples on Management Training
How to reach a national standard
AI tools evaluation grid, also considering their fairness to use for workers
Ways of learning

Group: T2 People, Skills and Ways of Working

Simon	Share UBA concept for AI. Training + Data related roles
Annalisa	
Sune	Provide support to Group and share knowledge
Stephan	
Davide	Share experiences in other networks and coalitions on AI
Alberto	
Matej	Identify information needs for AI Env. Impact
Erkki	Idnetifying needs and roles in my opganisation/network

- Write personas
- Sketch out workshop to identify roles and needs





T3: Data, Technologies and Infrastructure

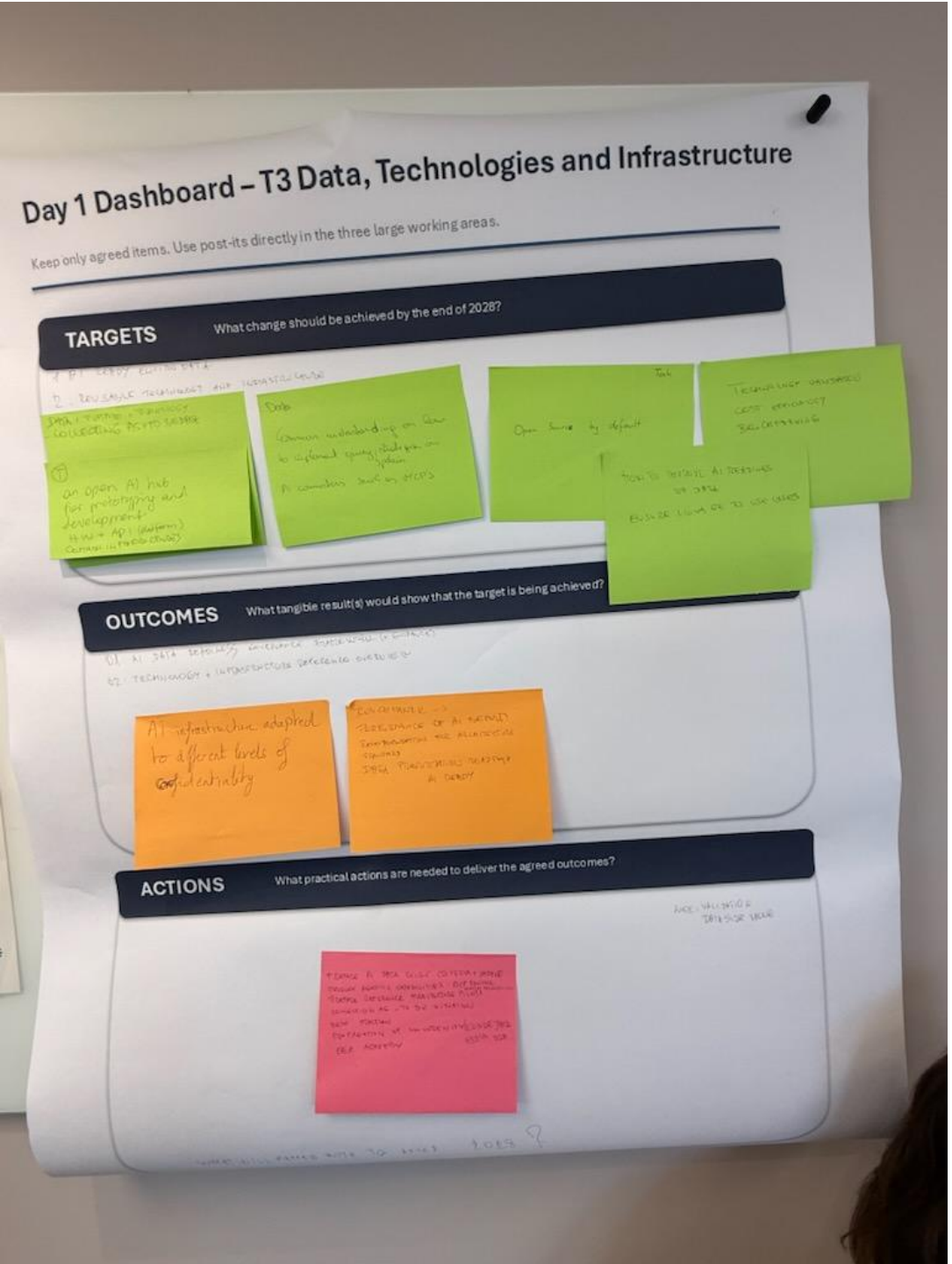
TARGETS

1. AI ready Environment data
2. Reusable technology and infrastructure

- Data + Platfom + Technology
- Collecting as is + to be data

- Establish an open AI hub for prototyping and development. HW + API – Platform, Common infrastructures

- Establish a common understanding of how to implement strategies and policies for data requirements for AI. AI connections such as MCPs
- Open source by default (Tech)
- Technology validation cost efficiency benchmarking.
- How to improve AI readiness of data, ensure linkage to use cases

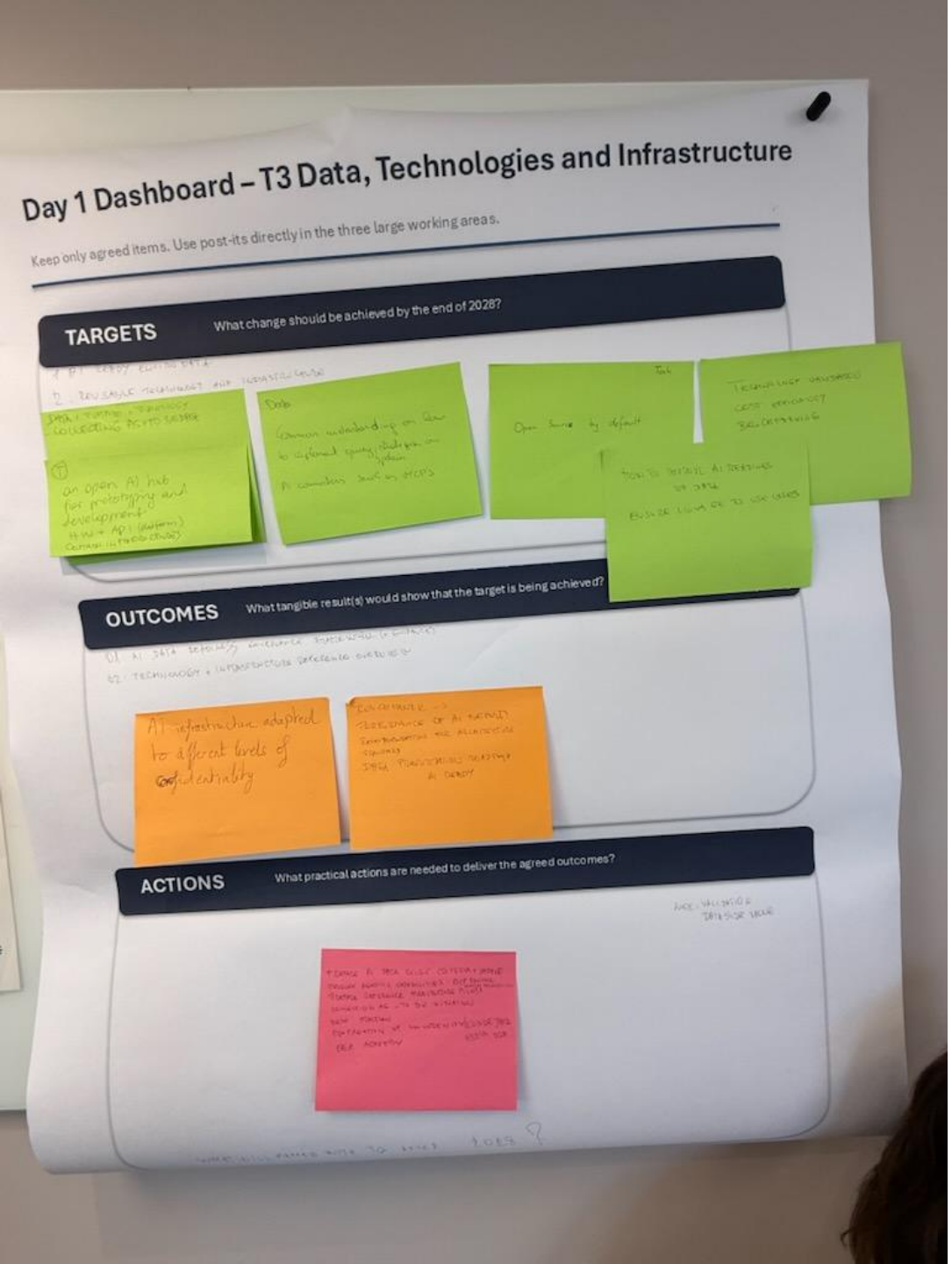


T3: Data, Technologies and Infrastructure

OUTCOMES

1. AI data readiness governance framework (+guidance)
2. Technology and Infrastructure reference overview

AI infrastructure adapted to different levels of confidentiality.
Benchmark - > Referance of AI platform recommendation for architecture standard
Data prioritisation roadmap and AI Ready



T3: Data, Technologies and Infrastructure

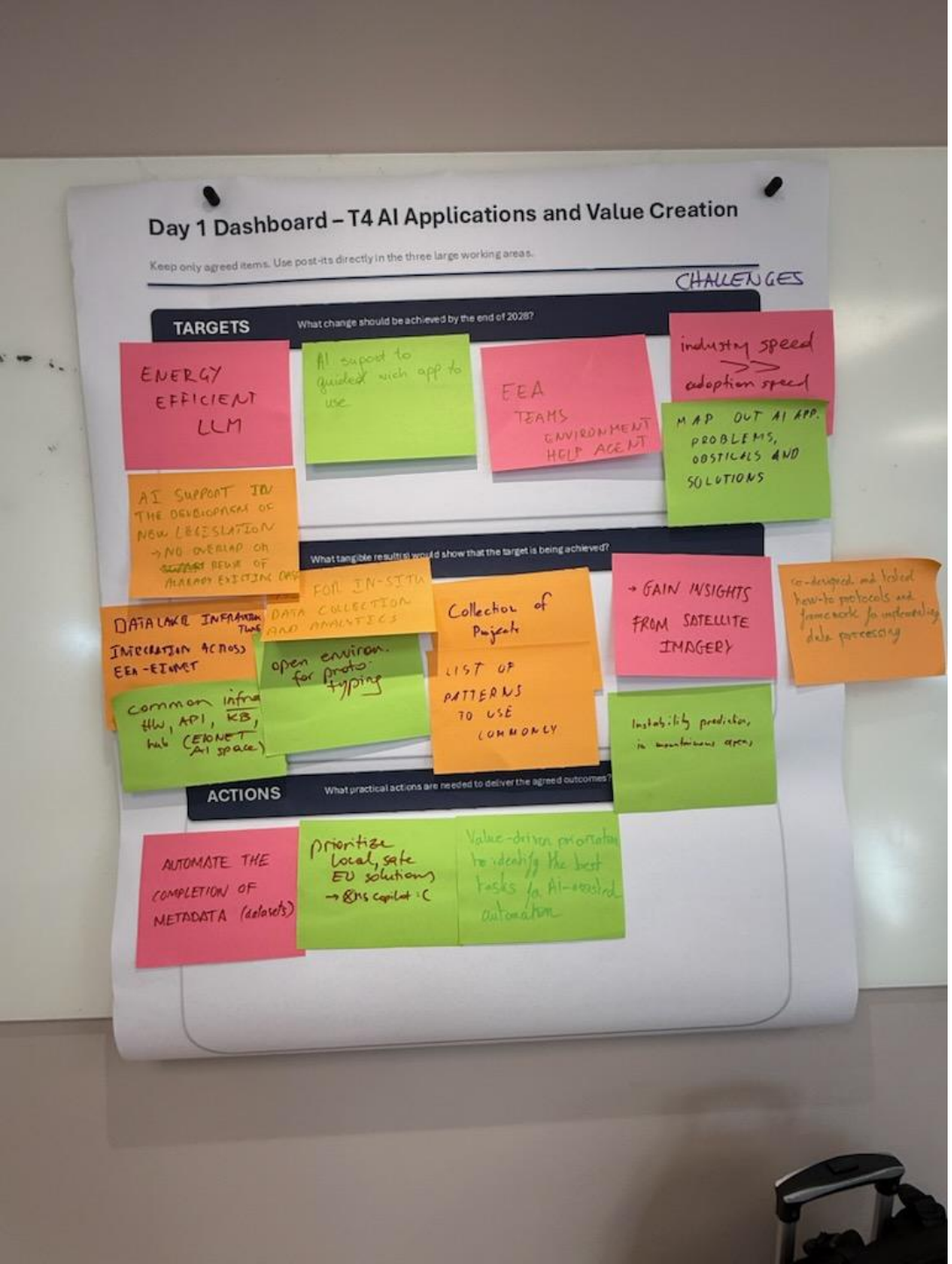
ACTIONS

Prepare AI data Reuse criteria + sample.
Develop agentic capabilities – MCP protocol
Prepare reference architecture pilots
Collect as is – to be situation
Best Practise
Propagation of Souvreignity (ensure data access)

Group: T3 Data, Technologies and Infrastructure

Martin T.	Share UBA concept for AI. Training + Data related roles
Annalisa	Start studying what IA-readiness implies for key institutions (ISPRA) data
Sune	Provide support to Group and share knowledge
Cecilia	Throw out a question to my national AI network if they have examples/templates of how they work with getting data AI-Ready
Taavi	Write down Estonian requirements
Marco	
Alberto	Collect legislation about AI with affect to data
Miro	First draft of data standard
L. Baltazar	Gathering European data models
Bino	
Tayakout Karim	Test data processing automation with AI

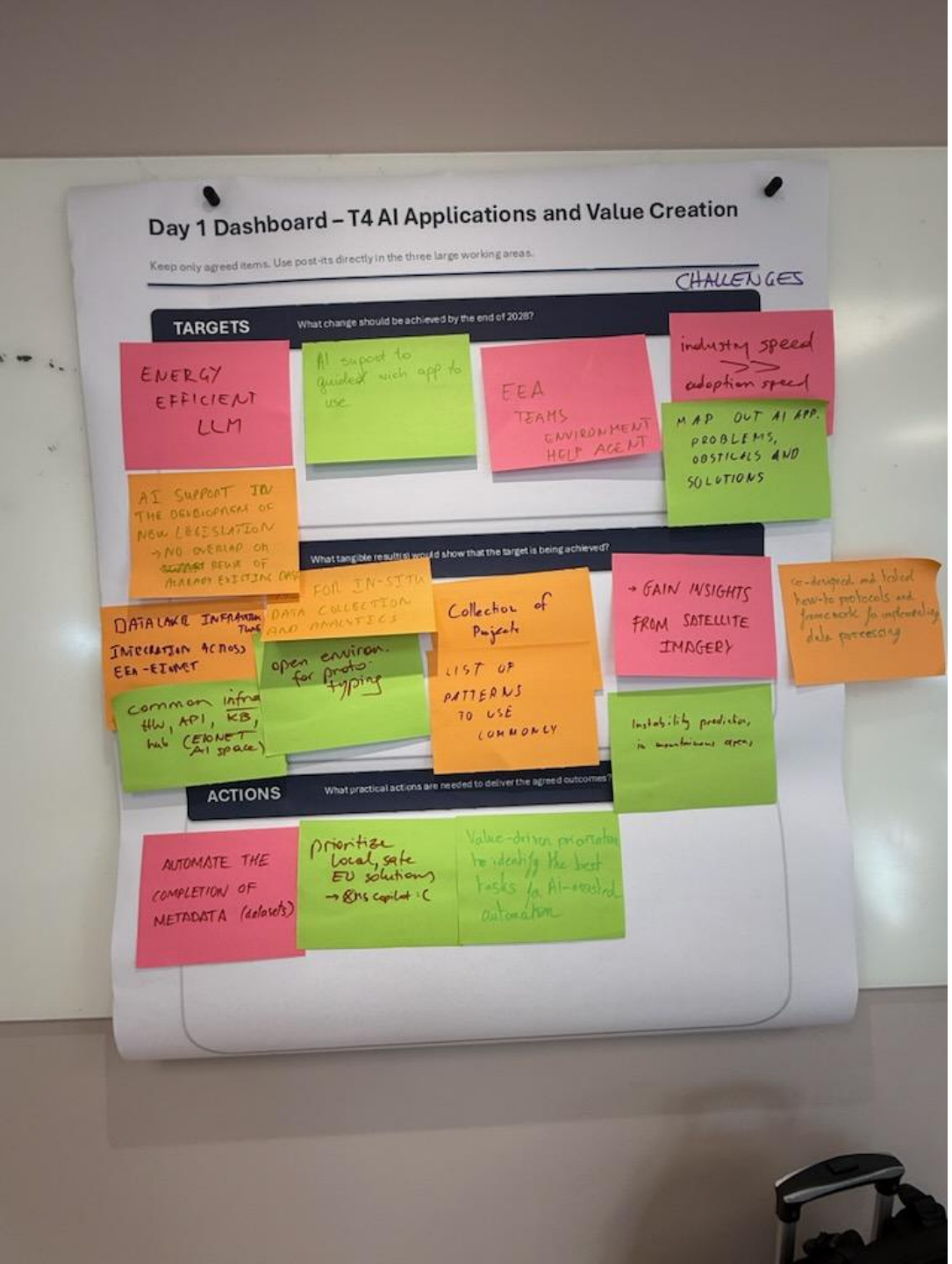




T4: AI Applications and Value Creation

TARGETS

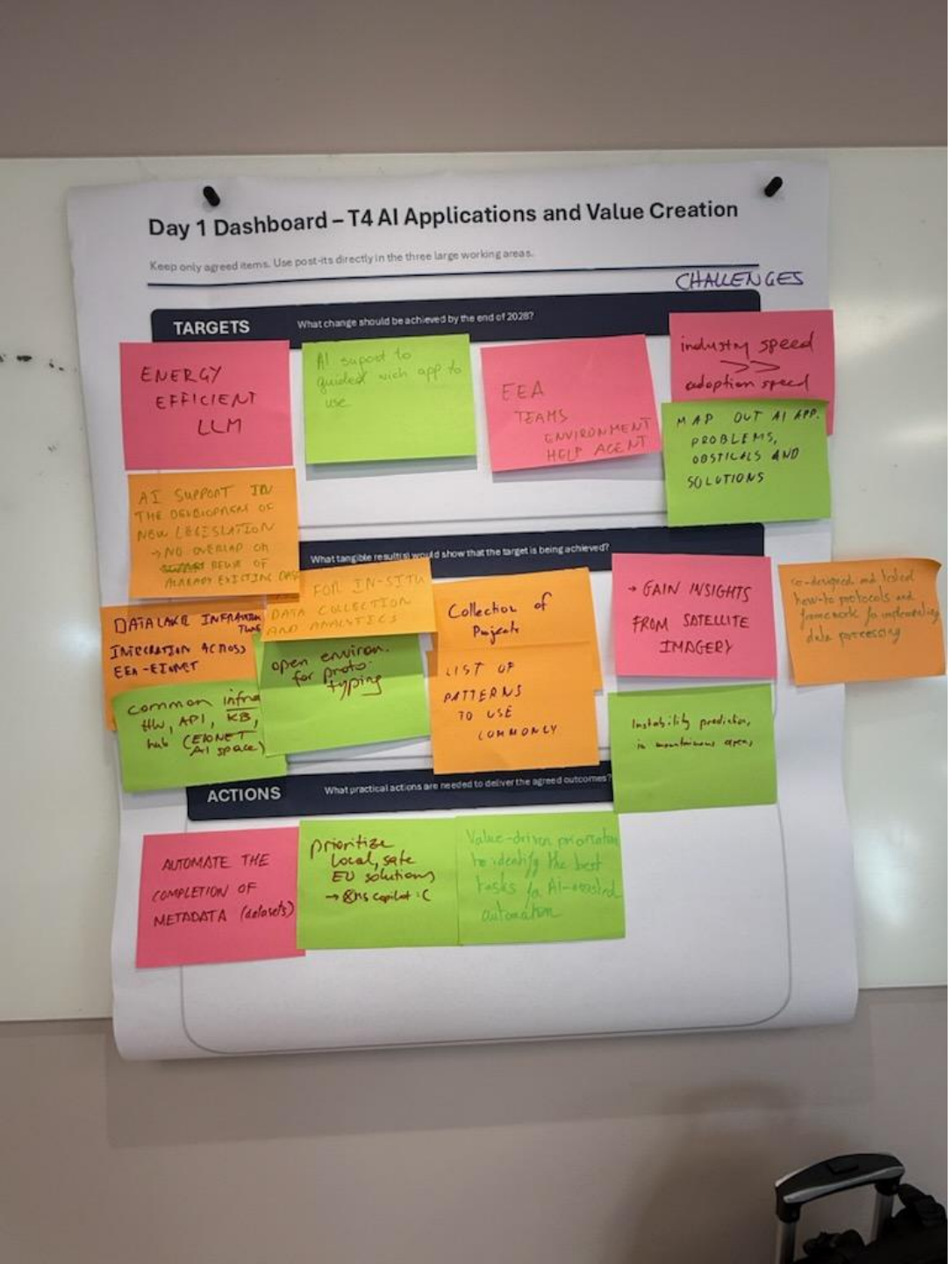
- Energy-efficient LLMs.
- AI support to guide which app to use.
- EEA teams environment help agent
- Industry speed >> adoption speed
- Map out AI app. Problems, obstacles and solutions
- AI Support in the development of new legislation -> no overlap or reuse of already existing data



T4: AI Applications and Value Creation

OUTCOMES

- Data Lake infrastructure integration across EEA-Eionet.
- Common infrastructure HW, API, KB, Hub (Eionet AI Space)
- AI for In-Situ data collections and analytics.
- An open environment for prototyping
- Collection of projects
- List of patterns patterns to use commonly.
- Insights derived from satellite imagery.
- Instability prediction on mountainous area
- Co-designed/tested how-to protocols and frameworks for data processing.



T4: AI Applications and Value Creation

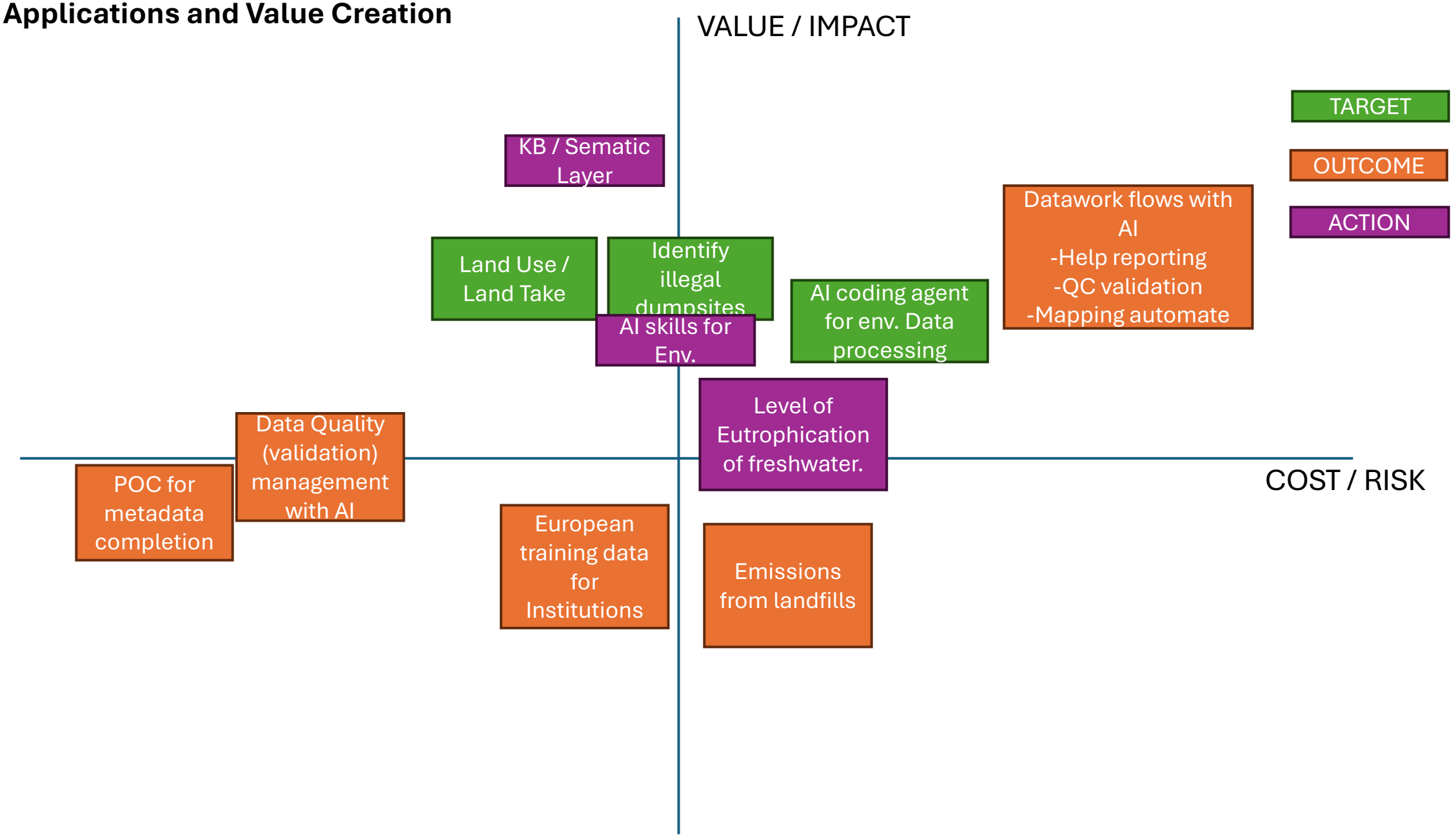
ACTIONS

- Automate completion of dataset metadata.
- Prioritise local, safe EU solutions. (not MS Co-pilot)
- Use value-driven prioritisation to identify the most suitable tasks for AI assistance or automation.

T4: AI Applications and Value Creation



T4: AI Applications and Value Creation



Group: T4 AI Applications and Value Creation

Gregor	Collect AI Use cases in text (struct.) Github templates + sample webpage
Martin T.	Share UBA concept for AI. Training + Data related roles
Ana	Talk about our own AI hub in our Ministry
Annalisa	Start studying what IA-readiness implies for key institutions (ISPRA) data
Sune	Provide support to Group and share knowledge
Juliana	
Simon	Share ”purpose first” approach
Bino	Further explore the MCP integration for hydrological db. and Api and report findings and lessons learned back to the group
Marco	
Tayakout Karim	Look for a use case with great value
Davide	Share some use cases
Matej	List of use cases from environment agency

Setting up a small template for a se case catalog




T1 STRATEGY
12 SKILLS
ERKKI
T3 DATA, INFRASTRUCTURE
T4 Application, Value Creation

Overwhelmed

Inspired

Optimistic

Positive

Curiosity

Tired

Hungry

Connection

Aligned

Progress

Interested

Productive

Motivated